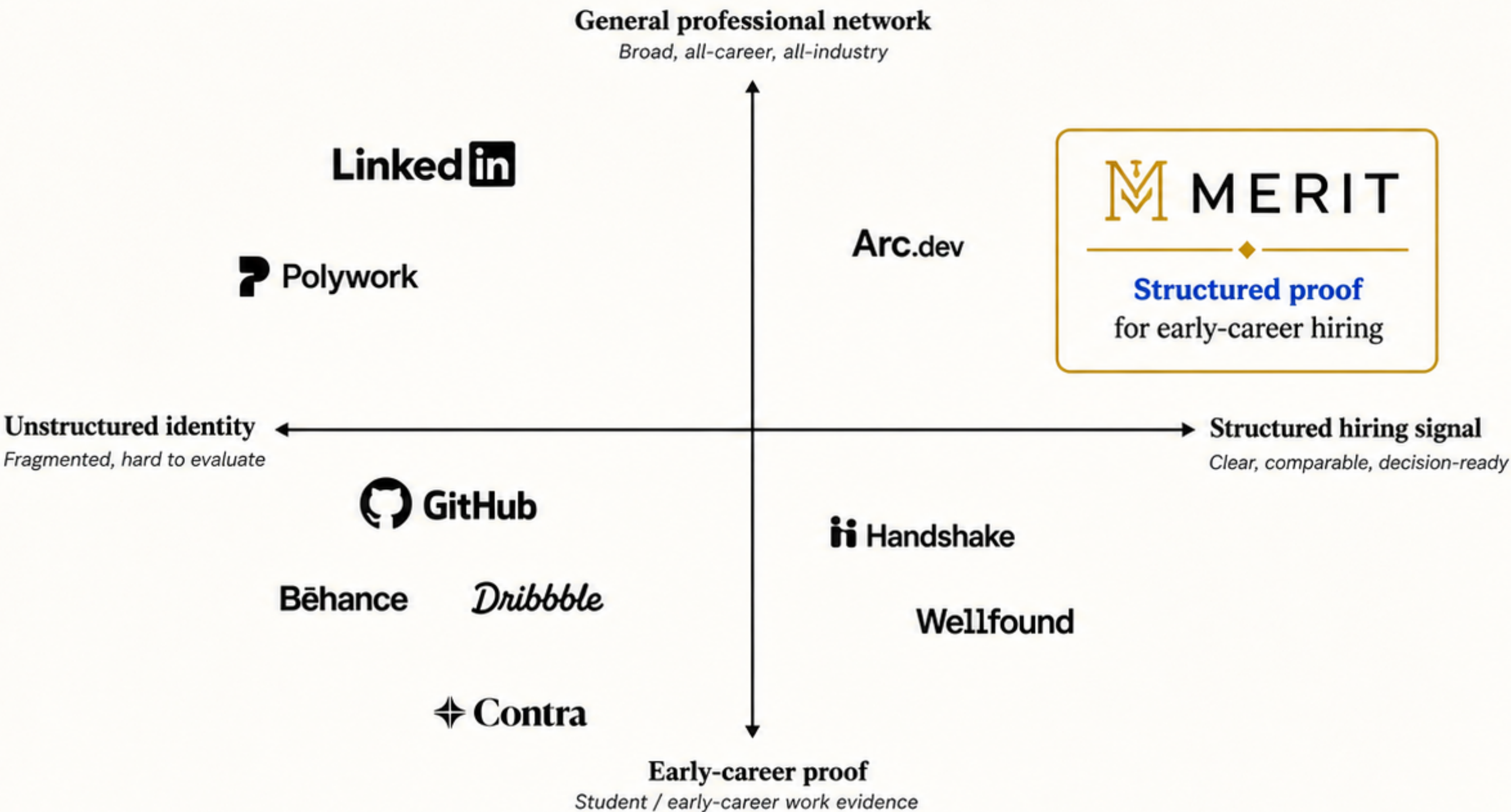


Where Merit Wins

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING MAP

MERIT
PROOF OVER PEDIGREE



POSITIONING INSIGHTS



LinkedIn = graph

Largest professional graph.
Broad coverage, weak early-career proof.



Handshake = campus access

Strong early-career network through schools and events.
Limited proof depth.



GitHub = code proof

Best-in-class for developers.
Narrow to code, not full candidate context.



Behance/Dribbble = visual showcase

Great for creatives.
Showcase-first, not hiring context.



Wellfound/Arc = hiring marketplace

Marketplace + outreach.
Focus on roles, not proof interpretation.



Merit = proof interpretation

Structured proof → role fit → recruiter understanding.

● NETWORK PLAY ● PROOF / SHOWCASE PLAY ● MARKETPLACE PLAY ● MERIT DIFFERENTIATOR

◆ Do not compete on network size first. Compete on recruiter understanding. ◆